Outbound Sales Platform: Build Spec

1. Purpose

An internal platform that helps our enterprise sales team run outbound to key accounts, covering both **new business** (net-new logos) and **existing business** (expansion, cross-sell, renewal and re-engagement with current customers). It reads account and contact data from Salesforce (enriched by ZoomInfo), applies MEDDPICC to every account, maps likely champions and detractors, generates multi-step outreach sequences using our own content, and requires human approval before anything leaves the platform. Every action is recorded in an audit log.

2. Users and roles

- **Rep**: sees their assigned key accounts, reviews and edits AI output, approves sequences.
- **Manager**: sees all reps' accounts, MEDDPICC coverage, sequence activity and the audit log. Can reassign accounts.
- **Admin**: manages Salesforce connection, field mapping, content library, prompt templates and users.

Reps also have a **team persona** (for example SDR/BDR, new business AE, account manager, CSM, sales leader), which sets what they see by default. See 6.4.

3. Hard constraints

- Build and test against a **Salesforce sandbox only**. Never connect to production without explicit instruction.
- **Every message has a named owner** from the team and must be approved by that owner (or an approver they delegate to) before it can be sent or used. No message can exist without an owner, and nothing is sent automatically.
- **No automation of LinkedIn actions.** LinkedIn's terms prohibit automated messaging, so LinkedIn steps are prepared in the platform and sent by the owner themselves (copy and open in LinkedIn), unless we later use an officially supported integration such as Sales Navigator.
- Salesforce access is **read-only** until write-back is explicitly enabled (Phase 4).

- All secrets in environment variables. Never commit credentials.
- Store only business-relevant contact data (name, title, company, business email, role history). No sensitive personal data.
- Contacts discovered outside the CRM are only sourced from licensed data providers (ZoomInfo first). No scraping of LinkedIn or other sites against their terms.
- First outreach to a newly discovered contact must include an opt-out and a link to our privacy notice (UK GDPR Article 14, PECR). Legal to confirm the exact wording.
- Maintain a suppression list (opt-outs, do-not-contact) that blocks generation and sending for those contacts.

4. Suggested stack

- Next.js + TypeScript (web app)
- Postgres (Supabase or similar) for app data and audit log
- Salesforce REST API via jsforce, OAuth through a connected app
- Anthropic API for research, analysis and message generation
- Simple email/password auth for v1, designed so SSO can be added later

Propose alternatives if there is a good reason.

5. Data model (starting point)

- **User**: id, name, email, role, team persona
- **BuyerPersona**: name (for example CMO, Head of Ecommerce, Head of CRM, CTO, CDO, CFO, Procurement), typical titles and seniority keywords for matching, priorities, typical pains, MEDDPICC relevance (which elements this persona usually owns), tone guidance, linked content
- **Account**: Salesforce id, name, industry, size, revenue, tech stack, intent signals, owner, customer status (prospect, customer, former customer), last synced
- **CustomerProfile** (existing customers only): products owned, contract start and end dates, renewal date, current ACV, account manager or CSM, open opportunities, recent closed-won and closed-lost, health or risk notes where available in Salesforce
- **Contact**: Salesforce id (empty until pushed), account, name, title, seniority, department, buyer persona, email, email verification status, LinkedIn URL, job-change flag, source (CRM or discovered), status (in CRM, suggested, approved, rejected), last synced
- **KeyAccountAssignment**: rep, account, motion (new business, expansion, cross-sell, renewal, re-engagement), priority, assigned by, assigned at
- **MeddpiccRecord**: account (and optional opportunity), one entry per element with

status, evidence, confidence, source (AI suggested or rep confirmed)

- **StakeholderAssessment**: contact, role (champion, detractor, neutral, unknown), influence (high, medium, low), rationale, evidence, source, confirmed by
- **ContentItem**: title, type, body or file, tags (industry, persona, MEDDPICC element, product), active flag
- **SequenceTemplate**: name, motion, steps (channel, delay, purpose, MEDDPICC focus)
- **Sequence**: contact, template, status (draft, awaiting approval, approved, active, paused, completed, stopped)
- **SequenceStep**: sequence, order, channel, scheduled date, owner, approver, generated content, edited content, status, approved at, sent at (or marked as sent by owner)
- **ChannelProfile**: channel, character and word limits, structure rules, tone guidance, call-to-action style, examples (configurable by admins)
- **AIDecision**: id, type (persona match, MEDDPICC hypothesis, stakeholder rating, content suggestion, account brief, message, discovered contact), target entity, conclusion, confidence, model, prompt template version, created at
- **EvidenceItem**: AI decision, claim, source type (Salesforce field, ZoomInfo field, content item, rep note, previous decision), source reference and value at the time, timestamp of the source data
- **Feedback**: AI decision, user, rating (useful, not useful), reason tags, free-text comment, edit diff if the rep changed the output, created at
- **Outcome**: sequence step or message, result (opened, replied, positive reply, meeting booked, opportunity created, unsubscribed, bounced), recorded at
- **Signal**: account, contact (optional), type, motion, description, source and evidence, detected at, data date
- **Alert**: signal(s), assigned rep, priority, status, due date, recommended action, linked action taken (sequence, task, note), dismissal or snooze reason, status history
- **AuditEvent**: id, timestamp, actor (user or system), action, entity type, entity id, before, after, metadata. Append-only.
- **Suppression**: contact or email, reason, added by, added at

6. Features

6.1 Salesforce sync

- Pull accounts, contacts and opportunities from the sandbox on a schedule and on demand.
- Configurable field mapping so ZoomInfo fields (intent, tech stack, scoops, job changes)

can be mapped without code changes.
- Show last-synced time and sync errors in the admin view.

6.2 Key accounts per rep

- Default assignment from Salesforce account owner, with manual override.
- Each rep has a configurable cap on key accounts.
- Rep home screen lists their key accounts ranked by priority and recent triggers.
- Manager view across all reps.

6.3 New business and existing business

Every key account has a motion, and the motion changes the data used, the triggers watched, the messaging and the guardrails.

New business (prospects)

- Triggers: intent surges, relevant new hires, tech stack changes (including competitor adoption or removal), funding, leadership changes, contacts who have moved from one of our customers.
- Messaging leads with pain, relevant case studies from similar companies and a clear reason to engage now.

Existing business (customers)

- Motions: expansion (more usage, regions, brands or business units), cross-sell (products they don't own), renewal, and re-engagement (after a champion leaves or engagement drops).
- Uses CustomerProfile data: products owned, renewal date, ACV, open and past opportunities.
- Whitespace view per customer: which products, brands, regions or business units are not yet covered.
- Triggers: renewal approaching (configurable window, e.g. 9 to 12 months out), champion or economic buyer job change, new stakeholder joining, new brand or region launch, intent on products they don't own, flat or declining engagement.
- Messaging references the existing relationship and proven results, and avoids cold-prospect language.

Guardrails for existing customers

- Outreach to a customer contact must be visible to, and optionally approved by, the account owner or CSM.

- Collision check: warn if another rep or an active sequence is already touching the same contact or account.
- Never start a sequence on a customer with an open escalation or support issue flagged in Salesforce, unless the account owner overrides it (logged in the audit trail).

Reporting

- Separate views and metrics for new business and existing business, by rep and by motion.

6.4 Team personas

Each team persona gets a default view, briefing style and set of recommended actions. Configurable by admins.

- **SDR/BDR**: prioritised contact lists, new contacts to approve, sequences awaiting approval, short call prep notes.
- **New business AE**: key prospect accounts, triggers, MEDDPICC gaps, buying committee coverage, account briefs.
- **Account manager**: customer accounts, whitespace, expansion and cross-sell triggers, renewal timeline, relationship risk.
- **CSM**: customer health, stakeholder changes, visibility of all sales outreach into their accounts, ability to flag or pause.
- **Sales leader**: pipeline created by motion and rep, MEDDPICC coverage, coverage of buying committees, sequence performance, audit log.

6.5 Buyer personas and persona-based messaging

- Every contact is matched to a buyer persona from title and department (AI suggests, rep can override).
- Admins define personas: priorities, pains, which MEDDPICC elements they typically own, tone and linked content.
- Messaging adapts by persona as well as motion. For example: a CMO hears about revenue and customer experience, a CTO about integration and data, a CFO about measurable ROI, procurement about commercial terms and risk.
- Sequence templates can have persona variants, so one sequence sends different copy to different people on the same account.
- Multi-threading: on one account, sequences across personas are coordinated so messages tell one consistent story rather than competing.

6.6 Contact discovery and coverage

Goal: find the people we should know about but don't have in Salesforce, and help reps reach them.

- **Coverage map**: for each key account, compare known contacts against the ideal buying committee (defined per motion and buyer persona) and show which roles are missing.
- **Discovery**: for missing roles, search ZoomInfo (via its API if our licence allows; otherwise generate a list for the rep to pull in through ZoomInfo's existing Salesforce integration). Additional licensed providers can be added later behind the same interface.
- **Email finding and verification**: take business emails from the provider, and verify deliverability before use. Unverified emails cannot be added to a sequence.
- **Review queue**: discovered contacts arrive as "suggested" with persona, reason they matter and source. A rep approves or rejects. Approved contacts are pushed to Salesforce (Phase 4), avoiding duplicates by matching on email and name plus account.
- **Alerts**: notify the rep when a relevant new person joins a key account, or when someone moves from a customer to a prospect.
- **Personalised content suggestions**: for each new or existing contact, suggest the content most likely to resonate, based on persona, role, seniority, motion, MEDDPICC gaps, previous employer (especially if they worked at one of our customers) and relevant public business activity such as company news or talks. Show the reasoning and let the rep pick.
- Discovery and approval actions are recorded in the audit log, including the data source for each contact.

6.7 MEDDPICC

Applied to every key account and every sequence.

- For existing customers, MEDDPICC is tracked per expansion, cross-sell or renewal opportunity, and starts pre-populated from what we already know (existing champion, past paper process, proven metrics). Changes since the last deal (for example a new economic buyer) are flagged as gaps.
- Elements: Metrics, Economic Buyer, Decision Criteria, Decision Process, Paper Process, Identify Pain, Champion, Competition.
- Each element has status (unknown, hypothesis, confirmed), evidence, confidence and source.
- AI proposes hypotheses from Salesforce data and the content library. Reps confirm, edit or reject. Confirmed items are clearly distinguished from AI suggestions.
- Account scorecard showing coverage and gaps.
- Gaps drive messaging: each sequence step should aim to uncover or progress at least

one specific MEDDPICC element, and the UI shows which.
- Manager view: MEDDPICC coverage by rep and account.

6.8 Champion and detractor mapping

- For each contact on a key account, AI suggests a role (champion, detractor, neutral, unknown) and influence level, with a written rationale.
- Signals to consider: seniority and department, relevance of role to our solution, tenure and recent job changes (including people who have joined from existing customers), opportunity and activity history in Salesforce, competitor tech in their stack, and any notes the rep adds.
- For existing customers, also use relationship history: who signed, who sponsored the original deal, who has gone quiet, and who has left. A departed champion is flagged as both a risk on this account and a new-business opportunity at their new company.
- These are hypotheses, labelled as such, until a rep confirms them.
- Visual stakeholder map per account (grouped by role and influence).
- Messaging adapts to role: champions get enablement and internal-selling material, detractors are not prioritised for cold outreach and are flagged for the rep to plan around.

6.9 Content library

- Admins and reps can add content: case studies, value propositions, persona guides, competitor battlecards, tone of voice guide, objection handling, past winning emails.
- Upload text, Markdown, PDF or Word, or paste directly.
- Tag by industry, persona, MEDDPICC element, product and motion (new business, expansion, cross-sell, renewal).
- Generation pulls the most relevant tagged content into context, and each generated message shows which content items were used.

6.10 Multi-step sequences

- Reusable templates with steps across channels: email, LinkedIn task, call task.
- Templates are tied to a motion, with starter templates for new business, expansion, cross-sell, renewal and re-engagement.
- Configurable delays between steps.
- Stop conditions: reply received, meeting booked, contact suppressed, manual stop.
- Per-contact personalisation using the account brief, MEDDPICC gaps, stakeholder role and content library.

- Every step is generated as a draft, editable by the rep, and needs approval.
- Sequence status visible per contact, per account and per rep.

6.10a Message ownership and approval

- Every sequence and every step has one named owner from the team. By default this is the rep assigned to the account; it can be reassigned (for example SDR to AE) with the change logged.
- The owner is accountable for the message: it is sent from, or by, the owner, under their name.
- Only the owner, or an approver they have delegated to, can approve a message. Approval is per step, not per sequence, so each touch is checked before it goes.
- Optional second approval from a manager for defined cases, for example C-level contacts, existing customers with open escalations, or first use of a new template.
- If an owner leaves or is away, their pending messages are paused and flagged to their manager for reassignment. Nothing proceeds without an owner.
- Approval screen shows the draft, the Explain panel (evidence and rationale), persona, motion, channel and any unsupported-claim warnings.
- Owner, approver, approval time and any edits are recorded in the audit log.

6.10b Multi-channel outreach

Sequences combine channels, and content is written specifically for each one rather than reused.

Channels

- Email (first touch and follow-ups)
- LinkedIn connection request with note
- LinkedIn message (to existing connections)
- LinkedIn InMail (Sales Navigator)
- Call (call script, talk track and voicemail script)
- Optional later: short video message script, event or webinar invite

Channel optimisation
Each channel has a ChannelProfile that the generator must follow. Limits are configurable because platforms change them; starting defaults:

- **Email**: subject line under 50 characters, 50 to 125 words, one clear ask, no heavy formatting, personalised first line tied to a signal.

- **LinkedIn connection note**: very short (keep within the platform's current limit, default 200 characters), no pitch, a genuine reason to connect.
- **LinkedIn message**: conversational, under 80 words, references something specific, light ask.
- **InMail**: short subject, under 100 words, clear relevance to their role.
- **Call**: 30-second opener, two or three discovery questions aimed at the account's MEDDPICC gaps, likely objections with responses, and a voicemail under 25 seconds.

Coordination across channels

- Channel order and timing set by the sequence template, with defaults per motion and persona (for example connect on LinkedIn, then email, then call).
- Each step knows what was said earlier, so messages build on each other and don't repeat.
- Stop conditions apply across channels: a reply on LinkedIn stops the email steps too (owner marks LinkedIn replies until an integration exists).
- The same content item can be used across channels, but rewritten to suit each one.

Tracking

- LinkedIn and call steps appear as tasks for the owner, with the copy ready to use and a "mark as done" with outcome.
- Outcomes and feedback are tracked by channel, so the dashboard shows which channels and channel mixes work best by persona and motion.

6.11 Account brief

- One-page AI brief per key account: what they do, recent triggers, likely pain, relevant case studies, MEDDPICC hypotheses and stakeholder map.
- For existing customers the brief also covers products owned, renewal date, whitespace, relationship health and recommended next motion.
- Refreshable on demand, with every version kept.

6.12 Audit log

- Append-only. No updates or deletes from the app.
- Records: syncs, motion changes, collision warnings and overrides, AI generations (model, prompt template version, inputs and content items referenced, output), edits (before and after), approvals and rejections, MEDDPICC changes, stakeholder rating changes, assignment changes, suppression changes, sends and write-backs.
- Each event has actor, timestamp, entity and action.

- Filterable by rep, account, contact, action and date range. Exportable to CSV.
- Visible from each account, contact and sequence, plus a global view for managers and admins.

6.13 Evidence log (how the AI reached its conclusions)

Every AI output is stored as an AIDecision with its supporting evidence, so anyone can see why it concluded what it did.

- The model must return structured output: the conclusion, a confidence level, a short rationale, and a list of specific claims, each linked to the source record it came from (for example "Head of Ecommerce joined from an existing customer: Contact.PreviousEmployer, synced 14 Oct").
- Assumptions and missing data are listed separately, along with what information would change the conclusion.
- Claims that can't be linked to a source are flagged as "unsupported" in the UI. Decisions with unsupported claims show a warning before a rep can approve them.
- The values of source data are snapshotted at generation time, so the reasoning still makes sense after the CRM changes.
- An "Explain" panel on every AI output shows the rationale, evidence, assumptions, content items used, model and prompt version.
- The rationale is a written explanation produced by the model alongside its answer, not a trace of its internal processing. Linking every claim to a source record is what makes it checkable.
- Evidence records are linked from the audit log and exportable alongside it.

6.14 Feedback loop

Reps' feedback and real outcomes improve the AI over time.

- **Inline feedback** on every AI output: useful or not useful, quick reason tags (wrong persona, wrong tone, factually wrong, too long, generic, off-message) and an optional comment.
- **Edit capture**: when a rep edits a draft before approving, the difference between AI draft and approved version is stored and treated as feedback.
- **Corrections**: when a rep overrides a persona match, MEDDPICC hypothesis or champion/detractor rating, the override and reason are stored as feedback on that decision.
- **Outcomes**: replies, positive replies, meetings, opportunities, bounces and unsubscribes are linked back to the message, persona, motion, content items and prompt version that

produced them (from Salesforce and the sequencer once connected).

- **Learning from it**:
  - Highly rated, approved messages with good outcomes become examples the generator can draw on, filtered by persona and motion.
  - A rolling summary of common feedback themes per prompt template is shown to admins, with suggested prompt changes. Admins approve any prompt change, which creates a new prompt version.
  - Content items are scored on how often they are used, kept and lead to positive outcomes.
  - Optional A/B testing of prompt versions or content angles on a share of new drafts.
- **Reporting**: AI quality dashboard showing approval rate without edits, average edit size, feedback themes, and outcomes by persona, motion, prompt version and content item.
- All feedback, prompt changes and A/B assignments are recorded in the audit log.

6.15 Daily signals, alerts and status tracking

Daily refresh

- A scheduled job runs every morning (configurable, default 06:00 UK time) after the Salesforce sync, and checks every key account and contact for new signals.
- Signal types include: intent surges, new joiners and leavers, job changes (including champions leaving and people moving from customers to prospects), new buying committee roles found, tech stack changes, renewal windows opening, engagement dropping, replies needing follow-up, sequences stalled, MEDDPICC elements stale or missing on active opportunities, and relevant company news.
- Admins can turn signal types on or off and set thresholds per motion.
- Each signal carries its evidence (source, value and date), shown through the same Explain panel as other AI outputs.

Alerts

- Signals become alerts assigned to the right person based on account ownership and team persona (for example renewal signals go to the account manager, new-joiner signals to the AE or SDR, customer risk signals also to the CSM).
- Related signals on the same account are grouped into one alert rather than several.
- Priority (high, medium, low) is set from signal strength, account priority, motion and deal stage, with the reasoning shown.
- Each alert includes a recommended next action, such as start a persona-based sequence, approve new contacts, update a MEDDPICC element or call the champion,

with one click to start it.

Status against each alert

- Statuses: New, Acknowledged, In progress, Actioned, Snoozed (until a date), Dismissed (reason required), Expired.
- An alert moves to Actioned automatically when the linked action happens (sequence approved, task completed, MEDDPICC updated), or a rep can mark it manually with a note.
- Target response times by priority (for example high within 1 working day, medium within 3), configurable by admins. Alerts past their target are flagged as overdue.
- Every status change is recorded in the alert's history and the audit log.
- Dismissal reasons and "was this useful" feedback feed the feedback loop, so low-value signal types can be tuned or switched off.

Dashboard

- **Rep view**: today's alerts in priority order, overdue items, and what's been actioned this week.
- **Manager view**: open, overdue and actioned alerts by rep and motion, average time to action, alerts that led to meetings or pipeline, and signal types the team finds most and least useful.
- Filters by rep, team persona, motion, signal type, priority, status and date.

Delivery

- In-app notifications and a daily morning digest by email.
- Optional Slack or Teams digest (later phase).
- Reps can set quiet hours and choose digest or real-time for high-priority alerts.

6.16 Salesforce write-back (Phase 4)

- Push approved discovered contacts to Salesforce with their source recorded.
- Log approved messages as activities against the contact.
- Create tasks for LinkedIn and call steps.
- Optionally write MEDDPICC fields to custom fields on the opportunity.
- Every write-back is recorded in the audit log.

7. Phases

1. **Foundations with mock data**: data model, auth, roles, audit log, key account

assignment, content library, using realistic seed data (UK retail accounts, a mix of prospects and existing customers with products owned and renewal dates). No external connections.

2. **Salesforce sandbox read**: connected app OAuth, sync, field mapping.
3. **AI layer**: buyer persona matching, team persona views, account briefs, MEDDPICC hypotheses, stakeholder mapping, coverage map, content suggestions, persona-based single-message generation with approval. Evidence log and inline feedback built from the start of this phase, not added later.
   3a. **Daily signals and alerts**: scheduled daily job, signal detection, alert assignment, statuses and target times, rep and manager dashboards, email digest.
   3b. **Contact discovery**: ZoomInfo search for missing roles (or rep-assisted pull if API access isn't available), email verification, review queue, new-joiner alerts.
4. **Sequences and write-back**: templates, multi-step generation, stop conditions, Salesforce activity and task write-back, outcome tracking, AI quality dashboard, prompt versioning and example library.
5. **Sending**: integrate with our existing sequencer or email platform rather than building our own sending infrastructure.

8. Quality bar

- Tests for audit logging, suppression checks, approval gates and Salesforce mapping.
- Prompt templates stored as versioned files, not hard-coded strings.
- AI outputs always shown as drafts with rationale and sources.
- All AI calls go through one service that enforces structured output, stores the AIDecision and evidence, and links feedback. No direct model calls elsewhere in the code.
- Clear, simple UI. Function over polish in early phases.

9. How to work

- Read this spec fully before writing code.
- Propose the architecture and a detailed Phase 1 plan first, and list any questions or assumptions.
- Build one phase at a time and stop for review at the end of each.
- Keep a short CHANGELOG.md and README.md with setup steps.